Gewu Insight - Windows Preview Guide

Experimental / Preview - functional parity is not yet accepted.

Development status

This is a Windows Preview for a NEW test Library. It is not the completed macOS-equivalent release. Existing macOS Library databases must not be moved into this build.

The shared Python service, SQLite model and research interface are reused. Native Windows integrations are still being connected and accepted separately. A visible control or a successful service test does not establish full workflow parity.

Install and start

Run the Windows Preview x64 Setup executable. Installation is per user and does not request administrator rights. The app includes Python and .NET; no developer environment is required.

Windows 11 x64 is the current test machine. The package targets Windows 10 version 2004 or later on x64, but Windows 10 and ARM64 have not passed real-device acceptance. Microsoft Edge WebView2 Evergreen Runtime must already be installed.

Open Gewu Insight Preview from the Start menu. The first start creates a new Library. The local server listens only on 127.0.0.1. Research discovery, publisher downloads and API providers may require Internet access and provider settings.

Files and Library locations

File > Open Data Folder shows the actual Library location. New Libraries use %USERPROFILE%\Gewu Insight Preview. Existing Libraries use the verified physical folder recorded in %USERPROFILE%\.gewu-insight\preview-workspace.txt. If that selected database is missing, startup stops instead of creating an empty replacement. SQLite is authoritative.

Windows file opening uses the associated default application. Open in File Explorer or Show in File Explorer opens the file location. Additional Library/Space placements use managed .lnk shortcuts to the same real file; they are not independent PDF copies. Open the shortcuts to work with the same annotations.

Paper Files can remove a non-default attachment to the Windows Recycle Bin. A verified temporary backup and a private SQLite recovery journal protect database failures and interrupted deletion; startup completes pending recovery without overwriting a changed file. Shared files and external originals are retained. Restore a successfully deleted file from Windows Recycle Bin, then add it to Paper Files again to restore its association. Bulk permanent removal from Library Recycle remains blocked. Cross-drive moves still need acceptance.

Browser and native controls

Browser uses separate WebView2 views and a profile separate from the trusted Library interface. Home is local Favorites. Remote pages do not receive the workspace message bridge.

File, Edit, View, Loader, Settings and Help expose the shared workflows. Settings includes Naming Rule, PDF Rename Settings, Preview Settings, Website Links, arXiv Scope Settings, Open Source Settings, Field Settings and Font Size. Preview Settings shows Windows-supported choices only. Click the workspace or press Esc to dismiss an open menu. Clear Monitor Cache remains disabled.

Space opens the built-in preview; Up/Down follows the selected Paper File and Esc closes it. Scroll continuously through PDF pages with a mouse wheel or two fingers on the touchpad. Pinch or Ctrl+wheel zooms the PDF; horizontal scrolling pans the enlarged page. Page Up/Page Down scroll, Home/End reach the first/last page,

and thumbnails jump to a page. The additional Windows page/zoom/Text toolbar has been removed. Pages render on demand with bounded caching. Use Open in Default App for text selection, full PDF search, links, printing and annotations. This uses Windows file associations; Gewu has no separate default-reader setting.

Get PDF is inside Browser > Save to Gewu > Details, beside PDF link. It retrieves a discovered PDF with the current Browser profile and website session. The source page stays open. Only a readable PDF up to 64 MB is staged; Save to Library adds it after identity, file type and destination review. Show in Library locates the result. Sign-in means your authorized publisher or institution account; it never bypasses a subscription. Downloads accept reviewed publisher/repository hosts and check redirects; unverified sources are stopped, not assumed pirated. Authorized preprints are allowed. No piracy services are used. If an authorized download fails, retry on the website or choose an authorized local PDF. Explicit Save Download, sharing and source synchronization remain disabled.

Browser History supports choosing a time range and confirming Clear History. Bookmarks, files and website sign-ins are kept. Import accepts a bookmarks HTML file exported from your browser. Sync from Safari and Open Passwords are hidden on Windows. Ordinary webpage-initiated downloads use the Windows Save dialog; publisher and session behavior still need broader verification.

Loader > Import Folder opens a Windows folder picker. For an offline import select Skip metadata. Destination Folder shows where files will be copied within the current Library workspace. Drag a Paper Files icon or filename to File Explorer or a compatible application to copy/open the real file; the app never offers moving or deleting the owned source. File Explorer file drops into Library reuse the existing import workflow. Library folder drag-out is not connected. Different target applications and cross-window drops still require broader acceptance.

Images, text and Markdown retain their existing built-in preview. The original file is not rewritten. PDF text extraction, large scanned PDFs, complex publishers and rapid repeated use still need broader real-document acceptance. macOS Passwords, Keychain AutoFill and WebKit sign-in profiles are not migrated.

Updates, uninstall and recovery

Close the application before installing an update. The installer updates application files only. Uninstall removes the app and preserves its separate Library, database, reports and browser profiles. Existing personal research data is never included in the installer.

Until backup/restore and old-Library migration pass acceptance, use disposable research files only. The retained data folder is not itself a validated backup. Do not replace a database with an older file or bulk-edit stored paths.

This development installer is unsigned. If Windows policy blocks it, do not disable Windows protection; the package requires an approved distribution/signing route. Startup errors are shown in the app; service diagnostics are under the workspace logs folder.

Windows guide

Help opens these Windows instructions in HTML or PDF. They describe the current Preview and contain no substituted macOS screenshots. Full feature parity is still being implemented and verified.